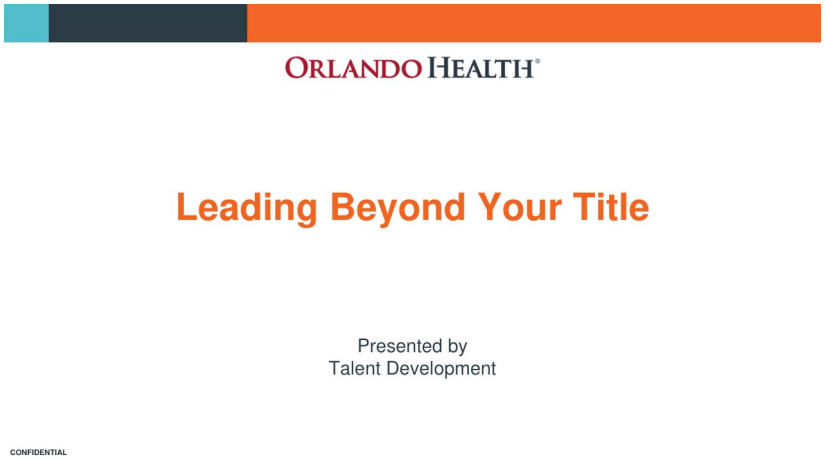
Leading Beyond Your Title

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Leading Beyond Your Title



TIMING: 1:00 | 0:00–1:00

SESSION: Target 13 minutes, including brief discussion. For 12 minutes, take one response per prompt. For 15 minutes, allow one additional example.

SAY:

Welcome to today's Nurse Leader Huddle. Many priorities depend on partnership with people outside our direct authority, including colleagues in pharmacy, imaging, environmental services, or another unit. A full schedule on both sides can make those requests difficult.

ASK:

Whose partnership do you need this week, even though that person does not report to you?

FACILITATE:

Allow 15 seconds of private reflection. Invite one brief example of the partnership, without sharing a confidential situation.

SAY:

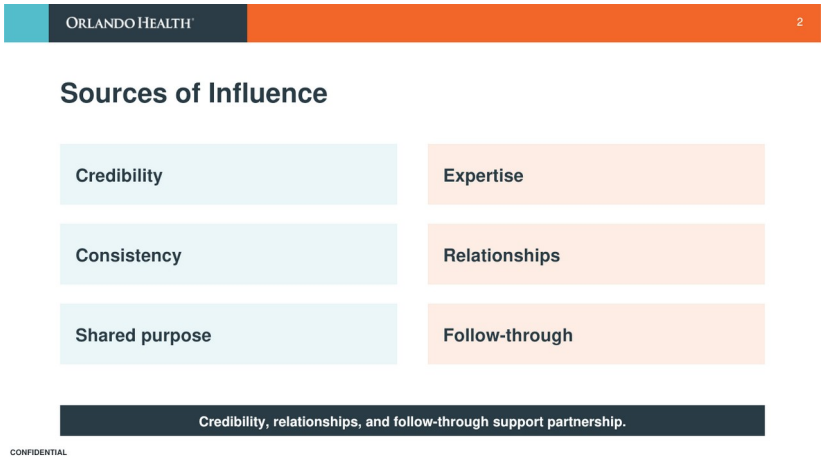
Today we will use three moves to prepare for that conversation and make a clear, workable request.

TRANSITION:

Let's start with what makes people willing to listen and collaborate.

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Sources of Influence



TIMING: 1:20 | 1:00–2:20

SAY:

Think about someone who influenced you even though they were not your direct leader. Hold that person in mind for a moment. Chances are you did not follow them because of where they sat on an org chart.

Often, influence is not created by a title. It is created through credibility, expertise, consistency, relationships, shared purpose, and follow-through. Notice that every one of these is earned in ordinary interactions, long before the moment you need something.

Sustainable influence is built when people trust our intent, respect our credibility, understand the shared purpose, and believe we will follow through. People respond to your credibility, relationships, and follow-through, as well as your title. Partnership still depends on capacity, priorities, and a workable request.

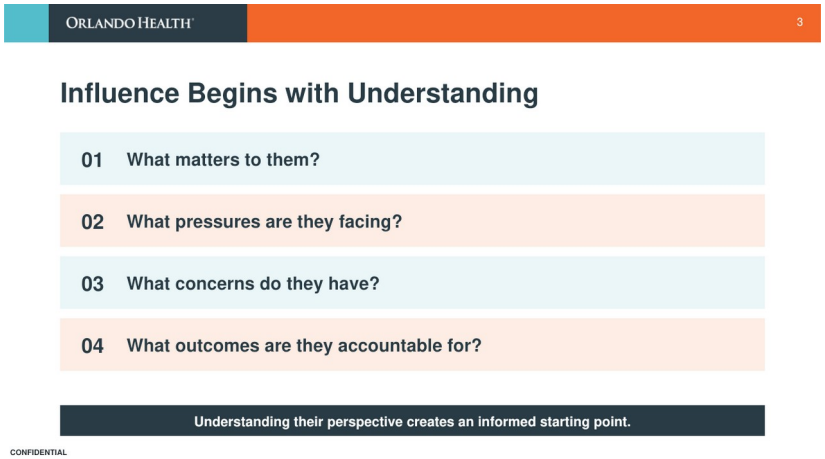
TRANSITION:

Many leaders assume influence starts with persuasion. Often it starts somewhere else.

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Influence Begins with Understanding



TIMING: 1:15 | 2:20–3:35

SAY:

Effective influence begins with understanding the other person’s perspective. Before advocating for what we need, it is important to understand the other person's reality.

What pressures are they facing? What outcomes are they accountable for? What concerns or risks do they see? What matters to them may be entirely different from what matters to us, and both can be legitimate at the same time.

Understanding does not mean agreeing with every concern. It means beginning the conversation from an informed perspective. When you can accurately describe someone's constraints before you make your request, the conversation changes character. You can frame the request around a shared problem and check whether your assumptions are accurate.

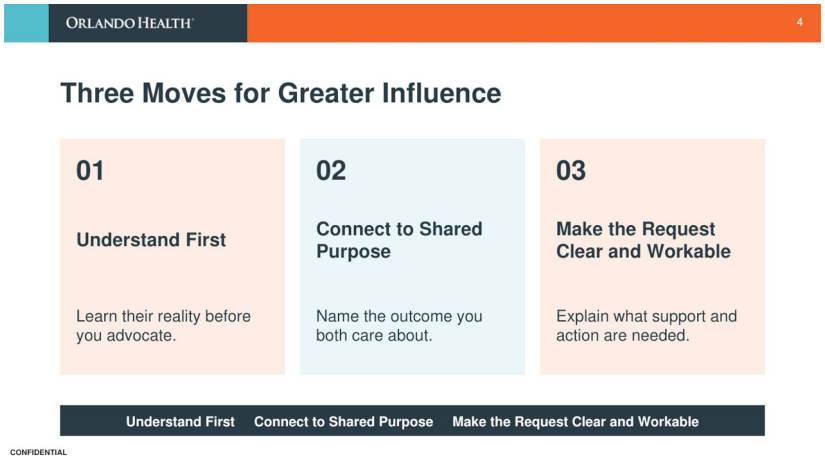
TRANSITION:

Influence becomes stronger when we can identify common ground.

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Three Moves for Greater Influence



TIMING: 1:25 | 3:35–5:00

SAY:

The three moves are Understand First, Connect to Shared Purpose, and Make the Request Clear and Workable.

Understand First means learning the other person's reality before advocating for your own request. Connect to Shared Purpose means identifying an outcome both of you care about. Make the Request Clear and Workable means explaining the action, timing, support, and next step while recognizing the partner's constraints.

These moves provide a sequence for the conversation. They do not guarantee agreement. They help both parties understand the request and discuss a realistic way forward.

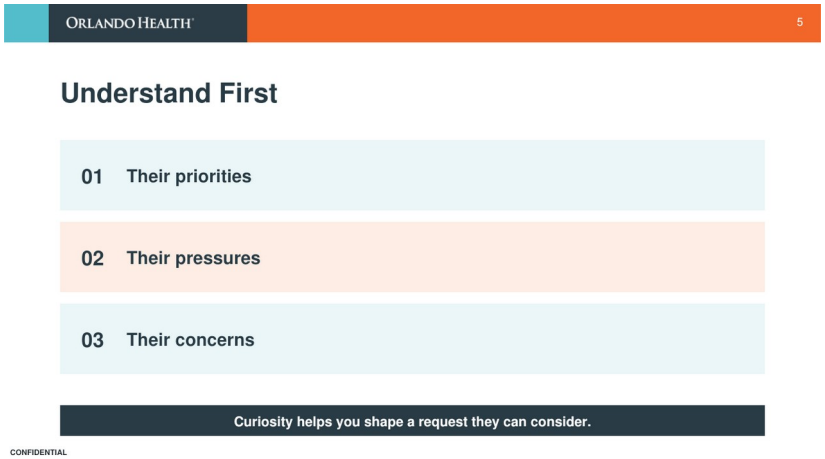
TRANSITION:

Let's start with understanding before advocating.

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Understand First



TIMING: 1:25 | 5:00–6:25

SAY:

Before asking for support, seek understanding. Ask yourself: What pressures might this person be experiencing? What outcomes are they accountable for? What risks do they see?

Leaders are often more successful when they begin with curiosity rather than persuasion. This can be as simple as one sentence at the start of a conversation: "Before I ask for anything, help me understand what your week looks like right now."

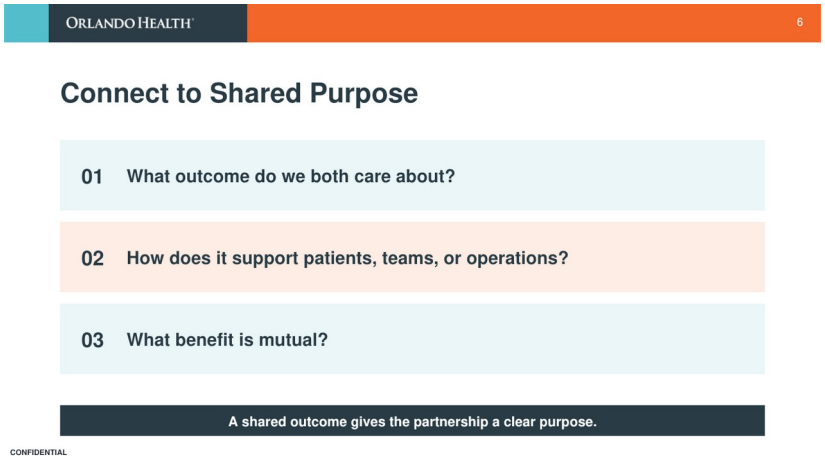
People are more likely to collaborate when they feel understood. What you learn can help you reshape the request or identify a constraint that needs to be addressed. Their priorities shape their response. Capacity may be an obstacle. Ask about risks rather than assuming what they are.

TRANSITION:

Once we understand the other person's perspective, we can focus on what we share.

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Connect to Shared Purpose



TIMING: 1:25 | 6:25–7:50

SAY:

Influence becomes stronger when we connect to something both parties value. Instead of focusing only on what our team needs, we should highlight the shared outcome.

The framing matters. "I need two hours of your team's time" is a cost. "We can both cut the delays our patients are waiting through" is a purpose. Explain the intended shared benefit without assuming that the improvement is guaranteed. Ask whether reducing those delays is also a priority for them.

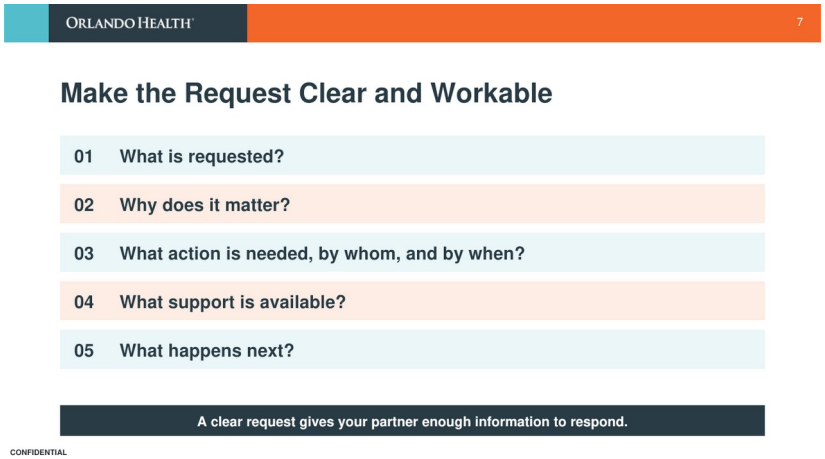
People support initiatives more readily when they understand the mutual benefit. A shared purpose provides a reason to work together. Clarify what each team would contribute and how you would recognize progress.

TRANSITION:

Once the purpose is clear, make the request clear and workable.

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Make the Request Clear and Workable



TIMING: 1:25 | 7:50–9:15

SAY:

Make the Request Clear and Workable. Use these five questions before making the request.

What is requested? State the specific decision or contribution you need.

Why does it matter? Connect it to the shared outcome.

What action is needed, by whom, and by when? Define responsibilities and timing.

What support is available? Name the information, resources, or help you can offer.

What happens next? Agree on the next step, how progress will be checked, and how concerns can be raised.

EXAMPLE:

“Could one representative review the proposed handoff with us for 20 minutes by Thursday? We want to reduce avoidable delays for both teams. I will send the current process and two specific questions in advance. After the review, we can agree whether a small test is workable.”

FACILITATOR TIP:

A clear request may still receive a no. Ask what constraint needs attention, consider an alternative, and follow through on anything you agree to do.

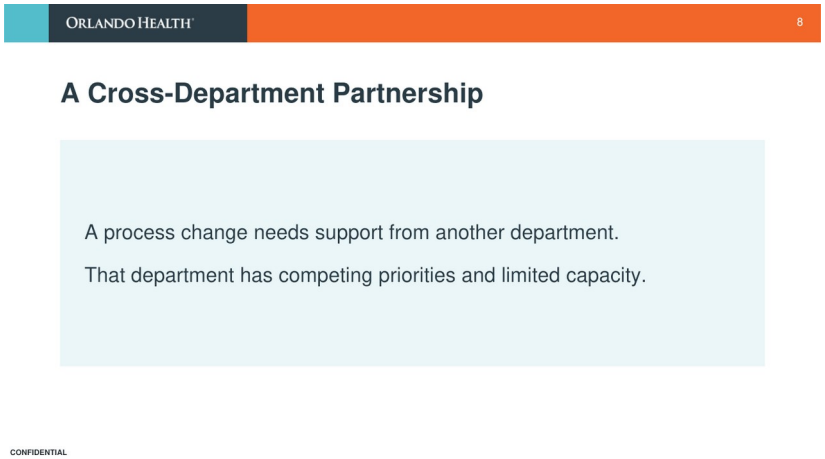
TRANSITION:

Let's apply all three moves to a partnership situation.

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A Cross-Department Partnership



TIMING: 2:15 | 9:15–11:30

SAY:

Your team wants to improve a process and needs support from another department. That department has competing priorities and is hesitant to commit capacity. You do not have direct authority over the partner team.

ASK:

How would you open the conversation and make a clear, workable request?

FACILITATE:

Allow 20 seconds of reflection, then invite two short responses. Ask participants to use the three moves rather than simply repeat the request more forcefully.

DEBRIEF:

Understand First: ask about the partner's priorities, pressures, and concerns.

Connect to Shared Purpose: identify an outcome both teams value, such as a smoother handoff.

Make the Request Clear and Workable: propose a bounded next step, identify who is needed and when, describe available support, and agree on what happens next. A short review conversation may be more workable than an open-ended resource commitment.

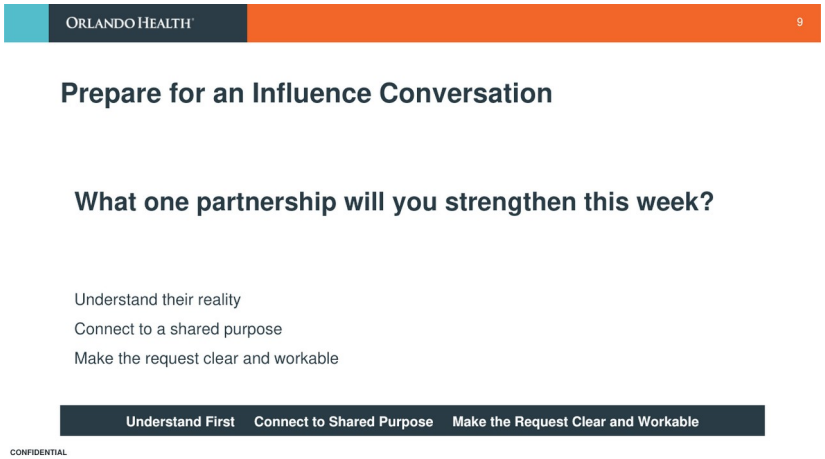
TRANSITION:

Now think about the partnership you identified at the beginning.

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Prepare for an Influence Conversation



TIMING: 1:30 | 11:30–13:00

SAY:

Choose one partnership that matters to a current priority. What do you need to understand about that person's reality? What outcome do both of you care about? What request can you make clear and workable this week?

CHAT ENGAGEMENT:

Allow 15 seconds of reflection. Ask: “In the chat, share one action you will take to strengthen a partnership this week.” Pause 20 to 30 seconds and acknowledge two responses. In person, invite brief verbal responses instead.

CLOSE:

Understand First. Connect to Shared Purpose. Make the Request Clear and Workable. Use those three moves in your next influence conversation and follow through on the commitments you make. Thank you for being here.